MODULE 2

Use Your Words

"The limits of my language means the limits of my world."

— LUDWIG WITTGENSTEIN

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How do people use words to express themselves?

MAIN STORIES

1	**Dear Primo: A Letter to My Cousin** · Duncan Tonatiuh	REALISTIC FICTION
2	**Adventures with Words** · Poetry Collection	POETRY
3	**The Upside Down Boy** · Juan Felipe Herrera	MEMOIR
4	**Dear Dragon** · Josh Funk	FANTASY

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NAME _____ DATE _____

A — Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 2 · Use Your Words · Grade 3 · 21 Items

CCSS L.3.4 · L.3.5 · L.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.3.6

express

When you **express** yourself, you —

- ◯ **A.** hide what you are feeling inside.
- ◯ **B.** copy exactly what a friend says.
- ◯ **C.** show what you feel and think.
- ◯ **D.** wait quietly without speaking.

Q2 L.3.6

convey

When you **convey** an idea or a feeling, you —

- ◯ **A.** make it clear so someone else understands it.
- ◯ **B.** keep it a secret from everyone.
- ◯ **C.** forget it right away.
- ◯ **D.** tear it into tiny pieces.

Q3 L.3.6

chronicle

A **chronicle** is —

- ◯ **A.** a clock that tells time.
- ◯ **B.** a story or account of a series of events.
- ◯ **C.** a kind of musical instrument.
- ◯ **D.** a single, unanswered question.

Q4 L.3.6

creative

Someone who is **creative** can —

- ◯ **A.** only follow rules that already exist.
- ◯ **B.** run faster than anyone else.
- ◯ **C.** remember long lists of numbers.
- ◯ **D.** imagine ideas and invent new things.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · DEAR PRIMO: A LETTER TO MY COUSIN

Q5 L.3.5 TRAP

video

Charlie likes to play **video** games. A **video** is —

- ◯ **A.** a kind of board game with cards.
- ◯ **B.** a written letter sent by mail.
- ◯ **C.** a recording of moving pictures and sound.
- ◯ **D.** a quiet room for reading books.

Q6 L.3.4

hydrant

On a hot day, Charlie cools off in water from a fire **hydrant**. A **hydrant** is —

- ◯ **A.** a pipe on the street that water comes out of.
- ◯ **B.** a tall window in a tall building.
- ◯ **C.** a kind of summer hat.
- ◯ **D.** a small farm animal.

Q7 L.3.5 TRAP

block

Charlie can walk around his city **block**. Here, a **block** is —

- ◯ **A.** a wooden toy you stack up.
- ◯ **B.** a section of a town with streets around it.
- ◯ **C.** a way to stop a soccer ball.
- ◯ **D.** a heavy stone used to build a wall.

Q8 L.3.4

costumes

For the parade, people wear bright **costumes**. **Costumes** are —

- **A.** the rules everyone must follow.
- **B.** the streets where parades happen.
- **C.** songs that people sing aloud.
- **D.** special clothes people put on for an event.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · DEAR PRIMO (CONTINUED)

Q9 L.3.4

march

In a parade, people **march** down the street. When you **march**, you —

- **A.** walk together with even, steady steps.
- **B.** crawl slowly on your hands and knees.
- **C.** sit very still in one place.
- **D.** jump high into the air.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · ADVENTURES WITH WORDS

Q10 L.3.4

desires

The poem speaks of the heart's simple **desires**. Your **desires** are —

- **A.** the chores you must finish.
- **B.** your wishes for certain things.
- **C.** the mistakes you have made.
- **D.** the names of your friends.

Q11 L.3.5 TRAP

entry

The poet writes a journal **entry**. Here, an **entry** is —

- **A.** a door you walk through to come inside.
- **B.** a prize won in a contest.
- **C.** a written note in a book or diary.
- **D.** a ticket for a train.

Q12 L.3.4

steep

Papi's truck climbs the **steep** mountain. A **steep** hill is one that —

- **A.** is flat and easy to walk on.
- **B.** is covered with soft grass.
- **C.** has a wide, smooth road.
- **D.** rises sharply and is hard to climb.

Q13 L.3.4

speed

The cars **speed** down the road. When something **speeds**, it —

- **A.** moves very quickly.
- **B.** stops all at once.
- **C.** turns around slowly.
- **D.** floats gently in the air.

Q14 L.3.5 TRAP

breezy

A **breezy** day blows fresh air into your body. A **breezy** day is —

- **A.** hot and still, with no air moving.
- **B.** windy, with a light wind blowing.
- **C.** dark and full of rain.
- **D.** cold enough to freeze water.

Q15 L.3.4

conductor

Juanito becomes the choir **conductor**. A **conductor** is a person who —

- **A.** paints pictures for a class.
- **B.** drives a school bus.
- **C.** directs a group of people who sing.
- **D.** cooks lunch for the school.

Q16 L.3.4

projects

The students work on school **projects**. **Projects** are —

- **A.** short breaks for play.
- **B.** books kept on a shelf.
- **C.** tests you take in one minute.
- **D.** tasks that take time and planning to finish.

Q17 L.3.4

assigned

The teacher **assigned** each student a pen pal. If someone **assigned** a task to you, they —

- **A.** gave it to you to do.
- **B.** took it away from you.
- **C.** hid it from you.
- **D.** finished it for you.

Q18 L.3.4

mosaics

The class makes **mosaics** in art. **Mosaics** are —

- **A.** songs sung by a choir.
- **B.** pictures made from many small pieces.
- **C.** letters written to a friend.
- **D.** long lists of new words.

Q19 L.3.4

retains

Blaise's father **retains** the fire-breathing record. If someone **retains** something, they —

- **A.** give it away to others.
- **B.** lose it by mistake.
- **C.** keep it and hold on to it.
- **D.** break it into pieces.

Q20 L.3.5 TRAP

precious

The dragon keeps a **precious** treasure in a box. Something **precious** is —

- ◯ **A.** heavy and hard to lift.
- ◯ **B.** old and ready to throw away.
- ◯ **C.** easy to find anywhere.
- ◯ **D.** worth a great deal and cared for very much.

Q21 L.3.5 TRAP

demolition

George's dad works in **demolition**. If you work in **demolition**, your job is to —

- ◯ **A.** tear down old buildings.
- ◯ **B.** build brand-new houses.
- ◯ **C.** paint walls bright colors.
- ◯ **D.** plant trees in a park.

B Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 2 · Use Your Words · Grade 3 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.3.1 · RL.3.2 · RL.3.3 · RL.3.5 · RL.3.6 · RI.3.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each story to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Story 1 · Dear Primo: A Letter to My Cousin

REALISTIC FICTION · DUNCAN TONATIUH · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.3.1

Who are Charlie and Carlitos to each other?

- ◯ **A.** They are teachers at the same school.
- ◯ **B.** They are brothers who share a room.
- ◯ **C.** They are cousins who write letters to each other.
- ◯ **D.** They are strangers who have never met.

Q2 RL.3.3

How is Carlitos's home in Mexico DIFFERENT from Charlie's home?

- ◯ **A.** Carlitos lives on a farm with mountains and trees.
- ◯ **B.** Carlitos lives in a tall city building.
- ◯ **C.** Carlitos lives next to a busy subway.
- ◯ **D.** Carlitos lives on a boat at sea.

Q3 RL.3.3

In his city, what does Charlie say he can see from his window?

- ◯ **A.** A wide field of corn.
- ◯ **B.** A river full of fish.
- ◯ **C.** A quiet mountain path.
- ◯ **D.** A bridge, cars zooming by, and skyscrapers.

Q4 RL.3.3

Charlie compares the city subway to a "long metal snake." What does this comparison help the reader picture?

- ◯ **A.** A real snake living in the city.
- ◯ **B.** A long train that twists and travels through the city.
- ◯ **C.** A toy that Carlitos sends in the mail.
- ◯ **D.** A snake that Charlie keeps as a pet.

Q5 RL.3.3 TRAP

Both cousins describe traditions they love. Which pair does the story actually name?

- ◯ **A.** In Mexico, the Day of the Dead; in America, Thanksgiving and Halloween.
- ◯ **B.** In Mexico, a skydiving contest; in America, a fire-breathing contest.
- ◯ **C.** In Mexico, a poetry reading; in America, a choir concert.
- ◯ **D.** In Mexico, a frog count; in America, a chess club.

Q6 RL.3.6

The story is told through letters that each cousin writes using "I" and "my." This lets the reader —

- ◯ **A.** hear only what a narrator outside the story thinks.
- ◯ **B.** see the story only through Charlie's eyes.
- ◯ **C.** learn what the city pigeons are thinking.
- ◯ **D.** hear each cousin's own thoughts about his daily life.

Q7 RL.3.5 TRAP

"Dear Primo" is REALISTIC FICTION told through letters. What makes it realistic fiction?

- ◯ **A.** A dragon writes letters to a human boy.
- ◯ **B.** The story is made up, but two cousins like Charlie and Carlitos could really exist.
- ◯ **C.** It is a list of true facts about Mexico.
- ◯ **D.** The whole story is written as a poem.

Q8 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA, or message, of "Dear Primo"?

- ◯ **A.** Living in a busy city with skyscrapers is better than living on a quiet farm.
- ◯ **B.** Cousins who live in different countries can never really understand each other.
- ◯ **C.** Two lives can look different on the outside but be alike in what matters, and words can connect them.
- ◯ **D.** Mexico and America are so different that the cousins find nothing in common.

Story 2 · Adventures with Words

POETRY COLLECTION · MULTIPLE POETS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.3.5

"Adventures with Words" is a collection of POEMS. What is one thing all the poems share?

- **A.** They all tell the story of one dragon.
- **B.** They all celebrate words and what words can do.
- **C.** They are all written as letters.
- **D.** They all give facts about farming.

Q10 RL.3.6

Who is the speaker of "I, Like You," and whom is the speaker talking about?

- **A.** A teacher writing about a whole class.
- **B.** A child writing about a pet that ran away.
- **C.** A narrator outside the poem describing two strangers.
- **D.** A person writing about herself and a friend she likes.

Q11 RL.3.2

In "Jokes," the children get together every day to do what?

- **A.** See who can tell the funniest joke.
- **B.** Write letters to their cousins.
- **C.** Sing songs as loudly as they can.
- **D.** Climb the tallest tree in the yard.

Q12 RL.3.2

In "I Go to the Land," the speaker says, "I drink. I think. I grow." What do these words suggest about words and learning?

- **A.** Words make the speaker tired.
- **B.** Words are only for grown-ups.
- **C.** The more the speaker takes in words, the more they learn and grow.
- **D.** Words should be kept secret.

Q13 RL.3.5

"There was an Old Man with a Beard" is a short, funny poem with a bouncy rhythm. A poem like this is called a —

- **A.** chapter.
- **B.** letter.
- **C.** limerick.
- **D.** recipe.

Q14 RL.3.3

In "Jokes," what does the character Crystal do that the other children cannot?

- **A.** She tells the funniest joke and always wins.
- **B.** She writes the longest letter to a cousin.
- **C.** She climbs the tallest tree in the yard.
- **D.** She paints the brightest picture in class.

Q15 RL.3.5 TRAP

How is a POETRY collection like "Adventures with Words" different from a story like "Dear Primo"?

- **A.** Poetry must always be about animals.
- **B.** Poetry can never share feelings.
- **C.** Poetry is always written by one person.
- **D.** Poetry uses the sounds and rhythms of words to share images and feelings.

Q16 RL.3.2 TRAP

What BIG IDEA do the poems in "Adventures with Words" share?

- **A.** Words are boring and hard to use, so it is better not to write poems at all.
- **B.** Words bring knowledge, music, friendship, and joy — and poetry is a way to express them.
- **C.** A poem is only a real poem when every single line rhymes, and nothing else.
- **D.** Telling jokes is the only good use of words, and the other poems do not matter.

Story 3 · The Upside Down Boy

MEMOIR · JUAN FELIPE HERRERA / ELIZABETH GÓMEZ · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.3.1

Why does Juanito's family decide to settle down in a city?

- **A.** So that Mama can open a store.
- **B.** So that Papi can join a choir.
- **C.** So that the family can buy a farm.
- **D.** So that Juanito can go to school.

Q18 RL.3.3

Why is Juanito nervous on his first days at the new school?

- **A.** He cannot find his classroom.
- **B.** He does not speak English yet and worries about being understood.
- **C.** He forgot his lunch at home.
- **D.** He does not like the color of the school.

Q19 RL.3.5

The memoir opens with a short note in italics that tells about the author as a boy. How does this opening note help the reader?

- **A.** It gives background so the reader understands what comes next.
- **B.** It gives the ending so the reader can skip ahead.
- **C.** It lists the new words taught later in the story.
- **D.** It rhymes to make the story sound like a song.

Q20 RL.3.3

How does Mrs. Sampson help Juanito feel like he belongs?

- **A.** She lets him stay home from school.
- **B.** She gives him a new name.
- **C.** She invites him to sing and tells him his voice is beautiful.
- **D.** She tells him to stop singing.

Q21 RL.3.3

Papi tells Juanito, "Each word, each language has its own magic." How does this help Juanito?

- **A.** It tells him to forget Spanish completely.
- **B.** It helps him feel proud of both his languages instead of ashamed.
- **C.** It makes him want to leave school.
- **D.** It teaches him a card trick.

Q22 RL.3.6 TRAP

"The Upside Down Boy" is a MEMOIR. What does that tell the reader about the story?

- **A.** It is a made-up tale about a talking animal.
- **B.** It is a letter written to a dragon.
- **C.** It is a list of facts about schools.
- **D.** The author is telling a true story about his own life and memories.

Q23 RL.3.6

Why does the author call himself "the upside down boy"?

- **A.** Because he likes to do handstands.
- **B.** Because he reads his books upside down.
- **C.** Because everything feels strange and turned around in his new, English-speaking world.
- **D.** Because he hangs from the monkey bars.

Q24 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Upside Down Boy"?

- ◯ **A.** With words, music, and encouragement, a newcomer can find his voice and his place.
- ◯ **B.** Singing in the school choir is the only way that anyone can ever learn English.
- ◯ **C.** A boy who moves to a new country should hide his first language and forget it.
- ◯ **D.** Moving to a brand-new place and learning a new language is always quick and easy.

Story 4 · Dear Dragon

FANTASY · JOSH FUNK / RODOLFO MONTALVO · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.3.1

Why do George and Blaise start writing letters to each other?

- ◯ **A.** They are next-door neighbors.
- ◯ **B.** Their teachers set up a pen pal project for their classes.
- ◯ **C.** They met at a soccer game.
- ◯ **D.** They are brothers in the same family.

Q26 RL.3.3

What does each boy WRONGLY imagine about his pen pal?

- ◯ **A.** Each thinks his pen pal is much older.
- ◯ **B.** Each thinks his pen pal cannot write.
- ◯ **C.** Each thinks his pen pal lives in Mexico.
- ◯ **D.** George imagines Blaise is a human, and Blaise imagines George is a dragon.

Q27 RL.3.3

Blaise writes that his father "still retains the record, melting fifty cubes of ice." What does this tell you about Blaise's family?

- ◯ **A.** They keep ice in a freezer to sell.
- ◯ **B.** They are humans who like cold weather.
- ◯ **C.** They are fire-breathing dragons, and his father holds a contest record.
- ◯ **D.** They run an ice-skating rink.

Q28 RL.3.3

What finally happens when George and Blaise meet at the picnic?

- **A.** They are surprised by how different they look, but stay friends anyway.
- **B.** They cannot find each other.
- **C.** They are angry that they look different.
- **D.** They decide never to speak again.

Q29 RL.3.5 TRAP

"Dear Dragon" is a FANTASY. What makes it fantasy and NOT realistic fiction?

- **A.** It has no pictures in it at all.
- **B.** It tells true facts about how dragons live.
- **C.** It is a memoir of the author's real childhood.
- **D.** One of the pen pals is a fire-breathing dragon who goes to school — something that could not be real.

Q30 RL.3.5

The two pen pals write their letters in rhyme. This makes the letters feel —

- **A.** playful and fun, like a poem.
- **B.** sad and serious.
- **C.** hard to read and confusing.
- **D.** exactly like a list of facts.

Q31 RL.3.6 TRAP

How does the reader learn the story of "Dear Dragon"?

- **A.** From one narrator outside the story who knows everything.
- **B.** From the letters the two pen pals take turns writing in their own words.
- **C.** From a TV news report.
- **D.** From a song the dragons sing.

Q32 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the BIG IDEA of "Dear Dragon"?

- **A.** You should only become friends with people who look the same as you do.
- **B.** Writing letters to a pen pal is a waste of time and never leads to a friendship.
- **C.** Words can connect people who seem very different, and you should not judge others by how they look.
- **D.** A dragon and a human are too different to ever get along or become real friends.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 2 · Use Your Words · Grade 3

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each story to think more deeply about how people use words to express themselves. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Perspective DOK 3

In **"Dear Primo,"** Charlie lives in a city and Carlitos lives on a farm. Their letters show TWO points of view on daily life. Compare what each cousin sees and does.

TWO COUSINS · TWO POINTS OF VIEW

CHARLIE · THE CITY	↔	CARLITOS · THE FARM

What do the two cousins have in COMMON, even though their homes look so different?

Q2 Communication DOK 2

This module shows MANY ways people use words. Show THREE different ways characters communicate across the stories.

THREE WAYS TO USE WORDS

LETTERS · DEAR PRIMO / DEAR DRAGON	POEMS · ADVENTURES WITH WORDS	SINGING · THE UPSIDE DOWN BOY

Which way of using words do YOU like best? Why?

Q3 Causation DOK 3

In **"The Upside Down Boy,"** Juanito changes from feeling lost to finding his voice. Map the CHAIN that helps him change.

CAUSE AND EFFECT · JUANITO FINDS HIS VOICE

Juanito's Voice

START · WHY DOES HE FEEL "UPSIDE DOWN"?

PAPI · WHAT DOES PAPI TELL HIM ABOUT WORDS?

MRS. SAMPSON · HOW DOES SHE HELP?

END · WHAT DOES JUANITO BECOME?

Which step helped Juanito the MOST? Explain your thinking.

Q4 Connection DOK 3

In **"Dear Dragon,"** two pen pals who look very different become friends through words. Trace THREE steps that connect George and Blaise.

THREE STEPS · FROM STRANGERS TO FRIENDS

STEP 1 · THE PROJECT

how do George and Blaise first start writing?

STEP 2 · THE MIX-UP

what does each one wrongly imagine about the other?

STEP 3 · THE MEETING

what happens when they finally meet — and stay friends?

Why are words able to connect two friends who look so different?

Q5 Form DOK 4

Essential Question: How do people use words to express themselves? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

How do people use words to express themselves in this selection?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

How do people use words to express themselves in this selection?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 2 · Use Your Words · Grade 3

MAP RIT 195 → 215 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the stories in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Word Jar

Nina loved new words. Whenever she heard a word she did not know, she wrote it on a slip of paper and dropped it into a jar by her bed. By spring, the jar was full. Inside were words like "gleam," "wander," and "marvelous." One rainy afternoon, Nina could not go outside. She felt bored and grumpy. Then she remembered her word jar. She shook out a handful of slips and spread them on the floor. She began to make sentences. "The cat will wander in the gleam of the moon." She laughed. The words felt like little gifts. Soon she had written a whole tiny story using only the words from her jar. When her mom came in, Nina read it out loud. "That is wonderful," said her mom. "Your words turned a boring day into an adventure." Nina smiled. She had learned that the words you collect can become the words you create with.

156 WORDS · LEXILE 420–470L · RIT 195–201

Q1 RIT 195 | Lexile 420L | Key Detail

What does Nina do when she hears a word she does not know?

- ◯ **A.** She asks her cat what it means.
- ◯ **B.** She says it out loud ten times.
- ◯ **C.** She writes it down and drops it into a jar.
- ◯ **D.** She forgets it right away.

Q2 RIT 197 | Lexile 430L | Cause & Effect

Why does Nina take out her word jar that rainy afternoon?

- ◯ **A.** Because she is bored and cannot go outside.
- ◯ **B.** Because her mom tells her to.
- ◯ **C.** Because the jar is too full to close.
- ◯ **D.** Because she wants to throw the words away.

Q3 RIT 199 · Lexile 450L · Inference

The passage says the words "felt like little gifts." This MOST likely means Nina —

- ◯ **A.** wrapped the words in paper.
- ◯ **B.** got the words for her birthday.
- ◯ **C.** gave the words away to a friend.
- ◯ **D.** felt happy and lucky to have so many words to play with.

Q4 RIT 200 · Lexile 460L · Vocabulary

In the passage, the word **wander** most nearly means —

- ◯ **A.** to fall fast asleep.
- ◯ **B.** to walk around without a set path.
- ◯ **C.** to shout very loudly.
- ◯ **D.** to eat a big meal.

Q5 RIT 201 · Lexile 470L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Word Jar"?

- ◯ **A.** The words you collect can become words you create with.
- ◯ **B.** A rainy afternoon stuck indoors is always boring, no matter what you do.
- ◯ **C.** Keeping slips of paper in a jar is the best way to stay neat and organized.
- ◯ **D.** Making up sentences about a cat is the only fun way to use new words.

Passage 2 · Sam's New Country

Sam moved to a new country where everyone spoke a language he did not know. At his new school, the words sounded like fast music he could not follow. When the teacher called on him, Sam's face went red. He wanted to answer, but the words would not come. At lunch, he sat alone. Then a girl named Lena sat down beside him. She did not speak Sam's language either, but she smiled and pointed at her sandwich. "Sandwich," she said slowly. Sam pointed too. "Sandwich," he repeated. They both laughed. Each day, Lena taught Sam one new word, and Sam taught Lena one word from his own language. Little by little, Sam began to understand. By winter, he could raise his hand in class. He still made mistakes, but he was not afraid anymore. Sam learned that you do not need to know every word to make a friend. Sometimes one shared word is enough to begin.

158 WORDS · LEXILE 480–530L · RIT 202–207

Q6 RIT 202 · Lexile 480L · Key Detail

Why is it hard for Sam at his new school?

- ◯ **A.** The school is very far from his house.
- ◯ **B.** Everyone speaks a language he does not know.
- ◯ **C.** He has lost his backpack.
- ◯ **D.** The classroom is too cold.

Q7 RIT 204 · Lexile 490L · Cause & Effect

What happens after Lena sits down and says "sandwich"?

- ◯ **A.** Sam gets up and walks away.
- ◯ **B.** The teacher sends them outside.
- ◯ **C.** Lena moves to a different table.
- ◯ **D.** Sam repeats the word, and the two of them laugh and begin to be friends.

Q8 RIT 205 · Lexile 500L · Inference

Why is Sam "not afraid anymore" by winter?

- ◯ **A.** Because, word by word, he has begun to understand and make friends.
- ◯ **B.** Because the teacher stopped calling on him.
- ◯ **C.** Because winter is his favorite season.
- ◯ **D.** Because he stopped going to school.

Q9 RIT 206 · Lexile 510L · Vocabulary

The passage says the new words "sounded like fast music he could not follow." Here, **follow** means —

- ◯ **A.** clap along to a beat.
- ◯ **B.** walk behind someone.
- ◯ **C.** understand or keep up with.
- ◯ **D.** turn down the volume.

Q10 RIT 207 · Lexile 530L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Sam's New Country"?

- ◯ **A.** You should only make friends with people who already speak your own language.
- ◯ **B.** You do not need to know every word to make a friend — one shared word can be a start.
- ◯ **C.** Sitting alone at lunch is the worst part of starting at a brand-new school.
- ◯ **D.** Learning a new language is impossible if you ever make a mistake when you speak.

Passage 3 · The Two Pen Pals

Mateo and Yuki had never met, but they were pen pals. Their teachers had paired up a class in Peru with a class in Japan. Every month, the students mailed letters across the ocean. Mateo wrote about the tall mountains near his town and the soup his grandmother made. Yuki wrote about the cherry trees in spring and the trains that raced past her window. At first, the two worried they had nothing in common. Mateo's home was so different from Yuki's. But as the letters went back and forth, they found surprises. They both had a little brother who was a pest. They both loved drawing. They both wished they could fly. By the end of the year, Mateo and Yuki felt like old friends, even though they had never heard each other's voices. Words on paper had carried their thoughts halfway around the world. A letter, they learned, is a bridge made of words.

156 WORDS · LEXILE 540–600L · RIT 208–212

Q11 RIT 208 | Lexile 540L | Key Detail

Where do Mateo and Yuki live?

- **A.** In the same town.
- **B.** On the same farm.
- **C.** Both on a ship at sea.
- **D.** Mateo in Peru and Yuki in Japan.

Q12 RIT 209 | Lexile 560L | Cause & Effect

Why do Mateo and Yuki worry at first?

- **A.** They do not like to draw.
- **B.** They think their homes are so different that they have nothing in common.
- **C.** They have lost their pens.
- **D.** Their teachers are angry with them.

Q13 RIT 210 | Lexile 570L | Inference

What helps Mateo and Yuki become friends, even though they never meet?

- **A.** They live close to each other.
- **B.** They call each other on the phone every night.
- **C.** The letters they write share their thoughts and the things they have in common.
- **D.** They are on the same sports team.

Q14 RIT 211 | Lexile 580L | Vocabulary

The passage says, "A letter is a bridge made of words." Here, a **bridge** means something that —

- **A.** connects two people or places that are far apart.
- **B.** floats on top of the ocean.
- **C.** is built only out of stone.
- **D.** carries cars across a river.

Q15 RIT 212 | Lexile 600L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Two Pen Pals"?

- **A.** Pen pals can only become friends if they live in the very same country.
- **B.** Two children who have never met can never find anything at all in common.
- **C.** Words in a letter can connect people across great distances.
- **D.** Letters that travel across the ocean take far too long to be worth writing.

Passage 4 · Anya Finds Her Voice

Anya had a stutter. When she tried to speak, the words sometimes got stuck, and she had to push them out slowly. In class, she hated being called on. Her cheeks would burn while the other students waited. So Anya stayed quiet, even when she knew the answer. One day, the class held a poetry reading. Each student had to share a poem aloud. Anya almost stayed home. But her teacher, Mr. Bell, gave her an idea. "Try reading slowly, like a song," he said. "Let the words take their time." Anya practiced for a week. When her turn came, she stood up, took a breath, and read her poem slowly, almost like singing. The words did not get stuck. The class was silent, then clapped. Anya had found a way to use her words that worked for her. She learned that her voice was worth hearing, even if it came out in its own way and its own time.

160 WORDS · LEXILE 610–680L · RIT 213–215

Q16 RIT 213 Lexile 610L Key Detail

Why does Anya hate being called on in class?

- ◯ **A.** Her words sometimes get stuck because she has a stutter.
- ◯ **B.** She never knows the answers.
- ◯ **C.** She cannot see the board.
- ◯ **D.** She does not like her teacher.

Q17 RIT 214 Lexile 630L Cause & Effect

What idea does Mr. Bell give Anya before the poetry reading?

- ◯ **A.** To skip the poetry reading and stay home.
- ◯ **B.** To ask another student to read for her.
- ◯ **C.** To read slowly, like a song, and let the words take their time.
- ◯ **D.** To memorize the whole poem backward.

Q18 RIT 214 Lexile 650L Inference

Why does reading "almost like singing" help Anya?

- ◯ **A.** It makes the poem much shorter.
- ◯ **B.** Going slowly, like a song, keeps the words from getting stuck.
- ◯ **C.** It lets her skip the hard words.
- ◯ **D.** It makes the class stop listening.

Q19 RIT 215 Lexile 670L Vocabulary

The passage says Anya "found a way to use her words that worked for her." Here, **found** most nearly means —

- ◯ **A.** picked up something off the ground.
- ◯ **B.** started a new club.
- ◯ **C.** lost track of.
- ◯ **D.** discovered or worked out.

Q20 RIT 215 Lexile 680L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Anya Finds Her Voice"?

- **A.** A student who has a stutter should never be asked to read aloud in class.
- **B.** It is always best to stay quiet in class, even when you know the answer.
- **C.** Reading a poem out loud like a song is easier than singing a real song.
- **D.** Your voice is worth hearing, even if it comes out in its own way and its own time.